

Why aren't people panicking about AI-induced energy crisis?

Posted by u/ExcessivePlumbing • 0 points • 8 comments

We all see what happened with RAM: as soon as they figured out a way to use it in AI, the price jumped by 500%.

We see major producers withdrawing from retail consumer market completely, because it's more convenient to sell at 5x to AI hyperscalers.

Now, these same hyperscalers build a trillion dollars worth data centers. Which will need power. We don't know how much, but estimates are "tens of nuclear power plants" (or similar number of large thermal plants).

The datacenters are to be built by 2030, and thing is, power plants take more than 5 years to build, in some cases much more. A nuclear plant can take more than 10, easily. Even if the building would start today, which it doesn't.

So somewhere between now and 2030 Oracle, Microsoft, Amazon, Google will create a tremendous demand for energy, same as they have created a demand for AI chips today.

Why shouldn't it go the same way it goes with RAM? Producers withdraw from retail market. Prices go up by 5x.

Why isn't anybody panicking? I mean, it's either that or an AI bubble burst. Is everyone expect the latter rather than the former?

Are we prepared to pay +500% for kWh?

Comments

u/NoStupidQuestionsBot • 1 points • 2025-12-11 16:06 UTC

Thanks for your submission /u/ExcessivePlumbing, but it has been removed for the following reason:

****Rule 2: Please try to use the search function before posting anything.****

Thanks for posting, but this question happens to be one that has been asked and answered here often before - sometimes in the same day! That can get frustrating for our dedicated users who like to answer questions. Or maybe you're just asking the same question too often - why not take a break for a while?

Sometimes questions that come up too often get put in our [Most Frequently Asked Questions list] (<https://www.reddit.com/r/NoStupidQuestions/wiki/index/faq/>). Other times, it may just be that we're getting a flood of questions about a topic (especially when something is in the news). Or maybe you keep asking the same question again and again - something that annoys our users here. Please don't do that! Next time, please try searching for your question first before asking. Thanks!

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u/SquelchyRex • 1 points • 2025-12-11 16:06 UTC

I have better things to do.

Best case scenario: this will push more governments to invest heavily in better energy efficiency.

Worst case scenario: I have to use candles at night.

u/Chubby_nuts • 1 points • 2025-12-11 16:05 UTC

Billionaires control media and own the platforms/DC's that are doing the consuming.

u/thierry_ennui_ • 2 points • 2025-12-11 16:03 UTC

Because panicking will solve absolutely nothing. We have no influence over the tech bros, and we simply can't stop them. If they decide that this is the future they want, then this is the future we'll get.

u/NotBorn2Fade • 2 points • 2025-12-11 16:02 UTC

People are being distracted by "culture war" bullshit while ignoring the true problems that could pose real danger in the long run. This is, of course, very convenient for those who profit from it.

u/montagblue • 1 points • 2025-12-11 16:16 UTC

Succinct and accurate.

u/mndsm79 • 2 points • 2025-12-11 16:01 UTC

Because they don't know. I would bet a donut and a chocolate milk that most people going "lol chatGPT" don't have the slightest clue what making their ass bigger with a.i. is really costing.

u/Due_Willingness1 • 2 points • 2025-12-11 16:00 UTC

There's a lot of reasons the world doesn't have a future worth living in, this one probably doesn't even make the top ten

Simply put people have bigger problems

u/ExcessivePlumbing • 1 points • 2025-12-11 16:02 UTC

It will be one of the top ten in 5 years easily. Energy price goes into absolutely everything. Energy price goes up - food price goes up.

I wonder what are the other 10 that are above that.